Interactive Portfolio Hero

A practical guide for creating the Sri Tech-style interactive portfolio intro

Concept

Create a portfolio hero where an animated character reacts to the visitor's cursor. The character starts by working on a laptop. Moving the cursor to the left or right makes her look in that direction. Moving the cursor to the center triggers the main greeting interaction, making the hero feel personal and interactive.

Step 1 — Create the Character Animation

Create one short, continuous character video using an AI video generation tool such as Google Flow. Keep the camera fixed and maintain the same character, clothes, laptop, lighting, and composition throughout.

Recommended action sequence:

1. Character works on the laptop.
2. She notices something and looks left.
3. She looks right.
4. She suddenly notices the visitor in the center.
5. She removes the headset and places it around her neck.
6. She waves hello.
7. She points down toward the portfolio.

Important: Keep the camera locked. Avoid zooms, pans, cuts, scene changes, or major composition changes. Leave some clean space above the character for the website navigation.

Step 2 — Create Frames From the Video

Take the generated video and create individual image frames from it. Keep the frame quality high enough for the website while optimizing the images for web performance. Organize the resulting frames in a dedicated folder so they can be used by the website animation.

The important idea is simple: **Video** → **Frames** → **Interactive Website Animation**.

Step 3 — Give This Prompt to Claude

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Build an interactive portfolio hero using the character frames created from my animation.

Use the existing project's current tech stack and do not rebuild unrelated parts of the project.

Create a premium, responsive hero where the character is the main visual focus.

INTERACTION

Divide the hero into three horizontal interaction zones:

LEFT:
When the cursor enters the left side, smoothly transition the character to the left-looking
reaction. Hold the reaction for approximately 2–3 seconds, then smoothly return her to the normal
working state.

RIGHT:
When the cursor enters the right side, smoothly transition the character to the right-looking
reaction. Hold the reaction for approximately 2–3 seconds, then smoothly return her to the normal
working state.
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CENTER:
When the cursor enters the center, trigger the main greeting sequence. She should look toward the visitor, become excited, remove the complete headset, place it around her neck, wave hello, and then point downward toward the portfolio.

Do not make the character literally follow the cursor. The cursor only selects the interaction zone.

Use smooth interpolation and requestAnimationFrame for responsive animation. Avoid unnecessary React re-renders.

VISUAL DESIGN

Make the character and laptop large and dominant in the hero. The entire laptop should remain visible and the character's head must not be cropped.

Keep enough space at the top for the navigation.

Use a premium light-maroon / dusty-rose gradient around the edges with a bright white glow focused behind the character. The center should remain mostly white, gradually transitioning into soft rose and light maroon toward the sides.

Keep the design minimal, modern, elegant, and readable.

Add a small left-side note:

"I'm Sushmita Dasari
Web Developer"

and a subtle supporting instruction:

"Move cursor to call me !"

Use an aesthetic modern font.

When the cursor is on the left, show a subtle contextual message such as:

"Anyone here on the left?"

When the cursor is on the right:

"Anyone here on the right?"

When the cursor is centered:

"Hey, it's you!"
"Hiiii!"
"Check out the portfolio"

Keep these messages small and elegant. Do not use emojis.

Add a subtle animated cursor indicator near the instruction text so visitors understand that the hero is interactive.

MOBILE

On mobile, remove the left/right interaction layout and focus on the center experience. Keep the character large, centered, and clearly visible with the laptop. Avoid horizontal scrolling and preserve the original proportions.

QUALITY

The character should be the visual anchor. Do not overload the hero with effects. Use subtle glow,

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shadows, smooth transitions, and clean typography.

Test desktop and mobile layouts and make sure the interaction feels smooth and intentional.
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Recommended Hero Structure

Area	Purpose
Top	Minimal navigation and brand name
Left	Personal intro + cursor instruction
Center	Large interactive character + laptop
Right	Contextual reaction message
Bottom	Portfolio exploration cue

Quick Checklist

• Create a consistent short character video.

• Create frames from the video and optimize them for the web.

• Add the frames to the portfolio project.

• Use the Claude prompt above to build the interactive hero.

• Make the character large and keep the laptop fully visible.

• Use a white center glow with light-maroon gradient edges.

• Use left / center / right cursor zones.

• Return to working after 2–3 seconds on left or right.

• Make the center interaction the main greeting moment.

• Test desktop, tablet, and mobile layouts.

The goal is not to make the page complicated. The interaction should feel simple: move left, she notices; move right, she notices; move to the center, she notices you and invites you into the portfolio.